

Answer Keys, Rubrics & Next Steps

Everything you need to score Progress Test 1 (Class 13) and the Final Test (Class 26): answers and point values, acceptable alternatives, the errors to expect, CEFR-aligned speaking and writing rubrics, what the scores mean for each learner's next class, and how to give the news kindly.

Progress Test 1 /70

Final Test /100

Rubric bands: Not yet A2 • A2 • A2+

Confidential • teacher only

SCORING PRINCIPLES

Score meaning, not spelling, in Listening and Reading: an answer that shows understanding gets the point, even if it is misspelled ("her cusin" for *her cousin* is correct). In Words, the word must be recognizable, so a small spelling slip (*pasport*, *lugage*) earns the point, but a different word does not. Grammar items are circle-only, so they are either right or wrong. The writing tasks and speaking use the checklists and rubrics below. Half points are not used. The tests use American English; **accept British forms everywhere** (the online lessons use some: *film*, *holiday*, *flat*, *return ticket*, *the bill*, *football*).

AT A GLANCE

SECTION	PROGRESS TEST 1 (MODULES 1-4)	FINAL TEST (MODULES 1-8)
 Listening	12 items • 1 pt each • /12	15 items • 1 pt each • /15
 Words	6 pictures + 4 time words • /10	12 pictures + 3 odd-one-out • /15
 Grammar	15 items • /15	20 items • /20
 Reading	6 yes/no + 2 short answers • /8	8 yes/no + 7 timetable questions • /15
 Writing	Invitation 4 + "My last weekend" 6 • /10	Message 8 + "Then, now, and next" rubric 12 • /20
 Speaking	Pair task, rubric 5 × 0-3 • /15	Interview, rubric 5 × 0-3 • /15
Total	/70 (written /55)	/100 (written /85)

PROGRESS TEST 1 • ANSWER KEY

1	We played football.	/d/ ending: a quick sound, no extra syllable
2	I'll go to the store.	the 'll is short: listen for it
3	They weren't at home.	
4	She's seen that movie.	she's + participle = present perfect
5	9:15	"nine fifteen"
6	\$3.40	"three dollars forty"
7	chicken	picture 3 (right)
8	umbrella	picture 2 (middle)
9	bus	picture 3 (right)
10	sister	
11	didn't swim	"so we didn't swim"
12	the mountains	the coast was last weekend

1	passport	6	cheese
2	ticket	7	ago
3	luggage	8	last
4	airport	9	ever
5	rice	10	next

Extra words: *hotel*, *sugar* (A) and *tomorrow* (B). For 3, accept *suitcase* or *bags* (real alternatives, even though they aren't in the box). Don't accept *luggages*: *luggage* is uncountable (Lesson 4.3). An added article (*a passport*) is fine.

◆ PART 4 • READING / 8

1	No	five days
2	Yes	
3	Yes	
4	No	"only a few postcards"
5	No	"for the first time"
6	No	next year
7	(With) her cousin	accept "cousin"
8	(To) a museum	accept "museum"

◆ PART 3 • GRAMMAR /15 • WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	were	they → were; <i>they was</i> is the common error	1.1
2	watched	finished past time (<i>last Saturday</i>) → -ed; same form for every person	1.2
3	went	irregular; <i>goed</i> doesn't exist	1.3
4	have	didn't + base verb; <i>didn't had</i> is the most common past-tense error	1.3
5	faster	one form only: never <i>more faster</i> ; <i>than</i> → comparative	2.1
6	most expensive	long adjective + <i>the</i> → <i>the most</i>	2.1
7	many	eggs = countable	2.2

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
8	is never	frequency adverb after <i>be</i>	2.3
9	well	adverb after a verb; <i>speaks good</i> is very common	2.3
10	is going to	<i>be</i> + going to + base verb	3.1
11	will	a decision made now → will; <i>going to</i> without <i>am</i> is wrong	3.2
12	going	<i>How about</i> + -ing	3.3
13	eaten	have + past participle	4.1
14	don't have to	not necessary (free); <i>mustn't</i> = not allowed	4.2
15	should	should + base verb (no <i>to</i> , no -s)	4.2

◆ PART 5 • WRITING /10

- ◆ **A. Invitation message (4 × 1 pt).** +1 an invitation or suggestion in a correct pattern (*Would you like to...? · Let's... · How about ...ing? · Why don't we...? · Shall we...?*). +1 an activity. +1 a day **and** a time. +1 a greeting or a friendly ending, and the whole message is understandable. Spelling slips don't lose points here.
- ◆ **B. My last weekend (6 pts).** Task 0–2: 2 = five or more sentences that answer at least four of the five prompts; 1 = three or four sentences, or only two or three prompts. **Accuracy 0–2:** 2 = past simple mostly correct (regular and irregular), including one negative with *didn't* + base verb, and a correct *going to* sentence; 1 = past forms attempted with several errors (*I didn't went, I go yesterday*); 0 = almost no past forms. **Linking 0–1:** *and, but, so, then* used correctly at least twice. **Mechanics 0–1:** capital letters and periods in almost every sentence.

Model answer A (4/4): Hi Ana! Would you like to go to the park on Saturday? Let's meet at 11 o'clock. See you soon!

Model answer B (6/6): Last weekend I was at home with my family. On Saturday I cleaned the kitchen, and then we cooked a big dinner. On Sunday it rained, so I didn't go to the market. We watched a movie. It was a quiet but happy weekend. Next weekend I'm going to visit my friend.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (PROGRESS TEST 1)

- ◆ **Missing past endings** in writing and speaking ("Yesterday I cook dinner"). Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai, and other speakers of languages without tense endings often leave them out, and speakers of Vietnamese, Korean, and Japanese may drop the final /t/ or /d/ sound. This also makes Listening 1 hard. Recycle the three -ed sounds in warmers.
- ◆ **"I didn't went" / "Did you went?"** (items 3–4, Part 5B). The single most common A2 error; it needs many short drills, not one explanation.
- ◆ **Present perfect with a finished time:** "I have been in Chicago last year." Speakers of Spanish, French, Italian, German, and Portuguese transfer their own perfect tense. Recycle the Lesson 4.1 golden rule: a time word → past simple.
- ◆ **"more cheaper" (5), "How much eggs" (7), "She never is late" (8), "speaks good" (9).**

- ◆ **Dropped *be* in *going to*:** "My sister going to start" (item 10; Arabic, Russian, and Chinese L1). **"How about go"** (12). **"mustn't" for "don't have to"** (14): the meaning mix-up is more serious than the form.

FINAL TEST · ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 · LISTENING /15

1	for 15 years	9	soccer ball
2	\$18.50	10	jacket
3	Thursday	11	a cough
4	since 2016	12	five days
5	the second right	13	he's working
6	throat	14	3:15
7	post office	15	Moreno
8	read		

Picture positions: 6 = right, 7 = middle, 8 = right, 9 = left, 10 = middle. Item 9: the script says *soccer*, the online lessons say *football*; either word is fine if a learner asks.

◆ PART 2 · WORDS /15

1	station	7	waiter
2	post office	8	bill
3	hospital	9	jacket
4	passport	10	jeans
5	luggage	11	stomach
6	menu	12	throat
13	platform	travel; the others are parts of a meal	
14	refund	shopping; the others are health problems	
15	fitting room	a clothes store; the others are train travel	

Extra words: *platform*, *receipt*. Accept *check* for 8, *clinic* for 3, *train station* for 1, *suitcase* for 5, and *server* for 7 (real alternatives, even though they aren't in the box). For 11–12 accept *stomach ache* / *sore throat*.

◆ PART 3 · GRAMMAR /20 · WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	were	you → were (even for one person)	1.1
2	go	didn't + base verb	1.3
3	cheaper	one form only; never <i>more cheaper</i>	2.1
4	much	money = uncountable	2.2
5	are going to	a plan; <i>be</i> is needed	3.1
6	am meeting	a fixed arrangement with a time → present continuous	3.3

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
7	been	<i>Have you ever been to...?</i> (experience; <i>gone</i> isn't offered)	4.1
8	has to	she → has to + base verb	4.2
9	was cooking	action in progress at a past moment	5.1
10	rang	the short, sudden action → past simple	5.2
11	While	<i>while</i> + background clause; <i>during</i> needs a noun (<i>during the walk</i>)	5.2
12	use to	after <i>did</i> , no <i>-d</i>	5.3
13	rains	no <i>will</i> in the if-clause	6.1
14	who	people → who	6.2
15	so	so + result (tired → went to bed)	6.3
16	do	<i>How do I get to...?</i> ; keep the <i>do</i>	7.1
17	enough	adjective + enough	7.2
18	since	a start point → since	8.1
19	yet	negative → yet, at the end	8.1
20	reading	enjoy + -ing	8.2

◆ PART 4 • READING /15

1	No	a small village
2	Yes	
3	Yes	
4	No	six years ago
5	Yes	
6	No	"harder than my old job"
7	No	"I haven't found a better job yet"
8	Yes	
9	9:05	accept "five past nine"
10	2	accept "platform two"

◆ PART 5 • WRITING /20

- ◆ **A. Message to the teacher (8 × 1 pt).** +1 greeting (*Hello / Hi / Dear* + name). +1 says they can't come. +1 says when (*tomorrow*, a day). +1 gives a reason. +1 the reason is joined correctly with *because* or *so*. +1 a plan to catch up with *will* or *going to* (*I'll do the online lesson*), or a polite question (*Can I...?*). +1 signs off with their name. +1 capital letters and periods throughout.
- ◆ **B. Then, now, and next (12).** Score with the **writing rubric** below: four criteria × 0–3.

Model answer A (8/8): Hello Ms. Park, I'm sorry, but I can't come to class tomorrow because my son is sick. I'll do the online lesson at home. See you on Thursday! Ahmed

Model answer B (A2+, 12/12): When I was a child, I used to live with my grandparents in a small town. We didn't have

11	Yes	change at Oakley
12	\$11.00	accept "11", "eleven dollars"
13	\$6.50	children under 12 travel free (\$13.00 = 0)
14	No	"You don't have to book."
15	the 11:10	45 minutes (the others take 50 and 70); accept "the 11:10 train", "11:10"

a car, so we walked everywhere. I've lived in this city for four years, and I've worked in a hotel since 2023. I've just finished my English course, but I haven't found a new job yet. Next year I'm going to study computers. If I find a better job, I'll bring my parents here for a vacation.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (FINAL TEST)

- ◆ **for / since and the present tense:** "I live here since 2019", "I've lived here since six years" (item 18, Part 5B). Spanish *desde hace*, French *depuis*, German *seit*, and Russian all use the present tense here. It's the most frequent A2-exit error, and B1 recycles it.
- ◆ **"Did you used to...?"** (12), **"If it will rain..."** (13), **"the woman which / who she works"** (14), **"enough big"** (17), **"I enjoy to read"** (20).
- ◆ **"Although..., but..."** in writing. Chinese, Vietnamese, and Arabic use paired contrast words, so learners add both. Accept the idea, but note it as a next step.
- ◆ **Past continuous for short events:** "When I was arriving, it snowed." Learners who have just met the past continuous overuse it. Check which action is the background.
- ◆ **Listening:** *fifteen / fifty* (1) and *eighteen / eighty* (2) still cause misses; item 13 is a reason, so learners who only catch "tired" circle the wrong answer. Accept only the right answer, but note it.

SPEAKING RUBRIC · BOTH TESTS

Five criteria, each 0–3 (total /15). 0 = no response, or only L1. The bands follow the CEFR qualitative aspects of spoken language (range, accuracy, fluency, interaction, phonological control). The A2 column paraphrases the Council of Europe's A2 descriptors (*CEFR Companion Volume*, 2020). For the progress test, judge against Modules 1–4 language only.

CRITERION	NOT YET A2 (1)	A2 (2)	A2+ STRONG (3)
Task & social language /3	Answers with single words or memorized A1 phrases; can't tell what happened or make a plan without a model.	Handles every stage with simple phrases: describes past events and experiences in a few linked sentences, makes and responds to suggestions, and gets through a simple everyday transaction (clinic, restaurant, ticket).	Completes every stage and adds detail without being asked (a reason, a comparison, a follow-up question); keeps the role-play natural and polite.

CRITERION	NOT YET A2 (1)	A2 (2)	A2+ STRONG (3)
Range (words) /3	Only A1 words; gaps stop the task, and the learner falls back on L1 or pointing.	Basic sentence patterns and memorized phrases for everyday needs: family, work, town, travel, food, health, plans. Sometimes has to search for words or simplify the message.	Enough language to vary the answers; can explain a missing word another way ("the place where you buy medicine").
Accuracy (grammar) /3	Mostly present tense for past and future; frequent errors hide the meaning.	Uses some simple structures correctly but still makes basic mistakes (mixing tenses, <i>didn't went</i> , missing -s). It is usually clear what they are trying to say.	Good control of the course's main patterns: past simple and continuous, <i>going to / will</i> , and (final test) present perfect + <i>for/since, used to</i> , first conditional. Errors rarely affect meaning.
Interaction /3	Answers only when helped; cannot ask a question, even with the card.	Asks and answers simple questions in short exchanges; can say when they don't understand and ask for repetition; needs the partner's help to keep going.	Starts, keeps going, and closes a short exchange; asks follow-up questions and reacts (<i>Really? When did you go?</i>); repairs breakdowns alone.
Pronunciation & fluency /3	Often hard to understand, even for a teacher who knows the learner. Long silences; single words.	Clear enough to be understood despite a noticeable accent, though the listener sometimes needs to ask for repetition. Short turns with obvious pauses, false starts, and reformulation.	Easy to follow; answers of several linked sentences with only short pauses; <i>-ed</i> endings, numbers, and times clear.

WRITING RUBRIC · FINAL TEST PART 5B

Four criteria, each 0–3 (total /12). 0 = nothing written, or nothing in English. At A2 the learner can write a series of simple phrases and sentences linked with simple connectors like *and*, *but*, and *because*, and short, simple notes and messages about everyday matters (paraphrased from the CEFR).

CRITERION	NOT YET A2 (1)	A2 (2)	A2+ STRONG (3)
Task /3	1–3 sentences, or only present-tense sentences; mostly copied from the prompts.	5–7 simple sentences that cover then, now, and next (at least four prompts).	All prompts covered in 7–8 sentences, with extra detail (reasons, comparisons, feelings).

CRITERION	NOT YET A2 (1)	A2 (2)	A2+ STRONG (3)
Range /3	Repeats the same few words and one tense.	Words for home, work, study, and plans; three or more different tenses or forms.	Some variety: <i>used to</i> , present perfect with <i>just / yet / for / since</i> , <i>going to</i> , an if-sentence, a comparative.
Accuracy /3	Most sentences have tense errors, and the meaning is often unclear.	Simple patterns mostly correct; errors in <i>for/since</i> , <i>used to</i> , or the if-clause, but the meaning is clear.	Nearly all sentences correct, including present perfect + <i>for/since</i> , <i>used to</i> , and <i>If + present, ... will</i> .
Linking & punctuation /3	A list of short sentences with no linking words; few capitals or periods.	Links ideas with <i>and, but, so, because</i> ; capitals and periods mostly used.	Several linkers used well (including <i>although</i> or <i>when/while</i>); commas with <i>so / but</i> and after an if-clause; few slips.

WHAT THE SCORES MEAN

◆ PROGRESS TEST 1 (/70): A DIAGNOSIS, NOT A VERDICT

SCORE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT TO DO IN WEEKS 7–13
56–70	Strong. Modules 1–4 are secure.	Give the stretch task in every lesson. Pair with a learner who needs support, as a helper, not a teacher.
42–55	On track, with gaps in one or two sections.	Point the learner to the online lessons behind their missed items (use the lesson column above). Recycle those points in warmers.
28–41	Needs targeted support.	A short one-to-one: which part felt hard? Agree on two online lessons to redo with 🎧 Listen, usually Lessons 1.3 and 4.1. Use the literacy-support options in every class. Check attendance.
0–27	Something is getting in the way.	Talk privately and gently. Check vision, hearing, literacy, attendance, and life stress, and whether the learner was placed at the right level. Re-check with the shared placement test ; the A1 course may be a better fit for now. Keep them welcome while you decide together.

Class analysis: add up each section for the whole class and divide by the number of learners. A section average under 60% is a class problem, not an individual one. Build a 5–10 minute recycle into the warmers of Classes 14–19 (for example, a "What did you do?" chain if the past simple is weak, which also sets up Module 5's storytelling; or a comparatives quiz if items 5–6 are weak).

◆ FINAL TEST (/100): GRADE TO OUTCOME

OUTCOME	GUIDELINE	WHAT TO TELL THE LEARNER AND PROGRAM
Ready for B1	70+ total and Speaking 10+/15 (mostly A2 or A2+ on the rubric).	Recommend Independent English (B1 Intermediate) , free online at rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/ . Learners at 88+ with Speaking 13+ are strong A2+ and can move quickly through the first B1 module.
B1 with a review plan	55–69 total with Speaking 8+, or 70+ with Speaking 8–9.	Move on to B1 with a written review plan : the 3–4 A2 online lessons behind their weakest items (see the lesson column), done with 🎧 Listen before B1 Week 3. Lessons 1.3, 4.1, 5.2, and 8.1 are the usual ones.
Repeat A2 with support	Below 55 total, or Speaking 7 or below.	Recommend a second lap of A2, framed as consolidation and not failure ("The second time is faster and easier, and your stories will be longer."). Add a conversation group or a volunteer tutor if your program has them. If the score was very low, re-check with the shared placement test.
Literacy pathway	Speaking 10+ and Listening 11+/15, but Reading + Writing under 18/35.	Oral English is ready for B1 and literacy is the barrier. Don't hold them back for literacy alone. Recommend B1 plus a reading and writing class or tutor. If B1 can't support them, repeat A2 with a literacy focus and say clearly why.

These are **guidelines**. Your thirteen weeks of observation count as much as one test on one day. A learner who was ill, anxious, or grieving on test day deserves a re-test or a quick re-check with the shared placement test before any "repeat" recommendation. Record the outcome and a one-line reason for your program.

GIVING FEEDBACK KINDLY

◆ PRINCIPLES

- ◆ **Private, always.** Never read scores aloud or return papers in score order.
- ◆ **Strength first, then one next step.** One concrete step, not a list of errors.
- ◆ **Name the progress.** Compare with Week 1, not with classmates.
- ◆ **Simple English, plus L1 if you share it.** Say the key message twice and check that it landed: "Next class: B1 or A2?"
- ◆ **Written note to take home,** because family members may help read it.
- ◆ **Adults decide.** Offer the recommendation and the reason, and let the learner choose when the

◆ PHRASES THAT WORK AT A2

You did a great job. 🌟

Your stories are really clear now.

You can book an appointment in English!

Practice this: I've lived here **for** two years / **since** 2024.

Do Lesson 8.1 again at home. Click 🎧 Listen.

Your next class: Independent English (B1). 🎉

One more A2 class. It's easier the second time.

I'm proud of you.

program allows it.

SAY: *Thirteen weeks ago you told me about yesterday. Today you told me your whole life story!*

SAY: *Your speaking is ready for B1. Reading and writing need more time, so let's find a reading class too.*

AVOID

Red ink everywhere, percentages without meaning ("62%"), the word "fail", comparisons ("Maria got 90"), and correcting a learner's L1 accent as though it were an error. If a learner cries or goes quiet, pause the conversation and come back to it. The number can wait.